PROPOSAL TO THE GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU

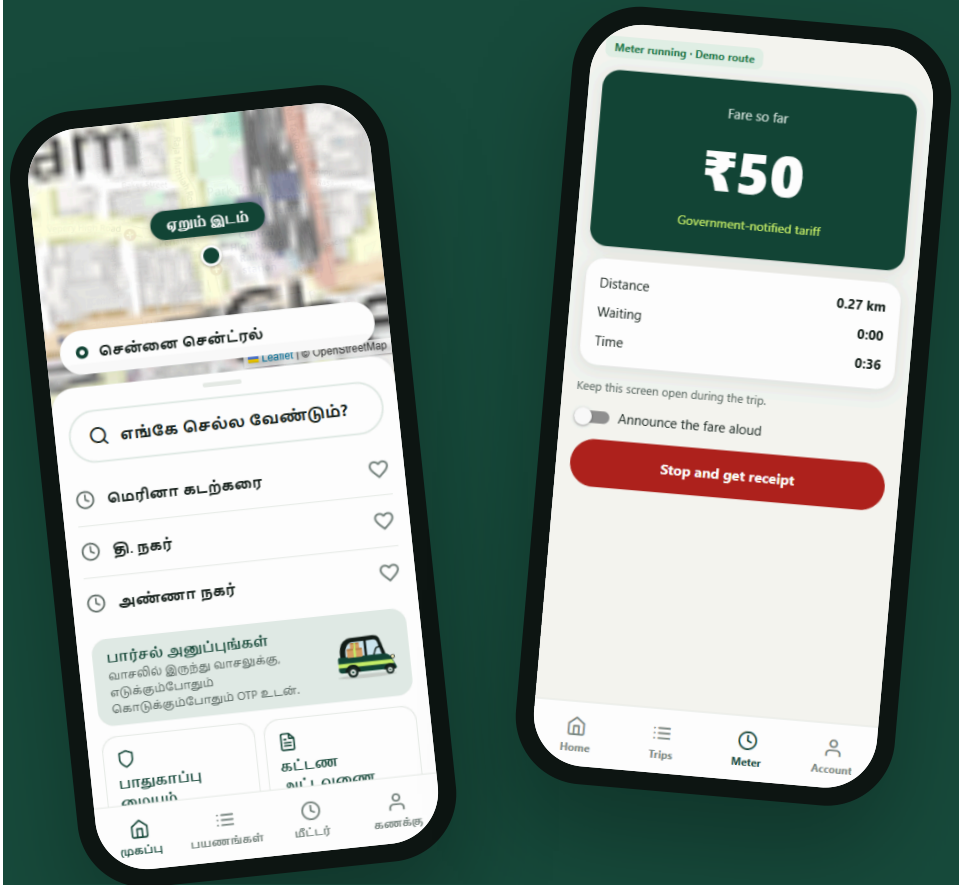
Every ride app serves its platform. Thozhan serves the Government's tariff.

தோழன் · நம் நகரம். நம் மக்கள். நம் பயணம்.

Thozhan is built around one thing no ride app offers today: **a digital auto meter controlled by the Government**. It runs on street-hail trips as well as app bookings, applies the notified tariff, and gives the passenger and the driver the same receipt, quoting the Government order.

Government sets the fare | Meter for street hails | Receipt quotes the G.O.

Public mobility data | Working Android app



30 min

Our request: one meeting

A 30-minute presentation to the appropriate officers of CUMTA, the Transport and Road Safety Department, the Transport Commissionerate, TNeGA, the Gig Workers Welfare Board, the Finance Department and the Police and emergency-response teams.

WHAT'S NEW

What no ride app does today

Today's ride apps set their own prices, cover only trips booked through them, and keep the trip data. Thozhan turns the meter into public infrastructure that the Government controls.

	TYPICAL RIDE APPS	THOZHAN
Who sets the fare	The company	**The Government's tariff order, applied automatically**
Street-hail trips	Not covered: only trips booked in the app	**The meter runs on any hailed trip**
Tariff changes	Each company decides if and when	**Configured once, applied statewide from the date in the order**
Receipt	The company's own pricing	**Itemised, quoting the G.O., the same for passenger and driver**
Trip data	Kept by the company	**Privacy-safe aggregates shared with CUMTA for planning**
Audit	No public access	**Every fare, fee and decision recorded for Government inspection**

Also included, as in other apps: SOS and 112 / 181 shortcuts, trip OTP, Tamil and English screens, and a flat daily fee for drivers instead of commission. These are standard in the market and are not what this proposal is about.

THE CENTRAL FEATURE

A digital auto meter the Government controls

The Government sets the tariff once; Thozhan applies it to every trip, booked or hailed on the street. It records the approved tariff, distance, waiting time and fare rules, and prints the same receipt for passenger and driver. Try it with the current notified auto tariff:

Trip distance 5.0 km

Waiting time 3 min

☐ Night trip (10 pm – 5 am, 1.5×)

- Works for app bookings **and** street-hail trips
- Tariff changes are made centrally, effective from the date in the order
- GPS distance measured on the phone and checked on the server
- Passengers can report an overcharge from the receipt

Receipt · same for passenger and driver

₹133

Government-notified tariff

Minimum fare (first 1.8 km)	₹50.00
Additional distance (3.2 km × ₹25)	₹80.00
Waiting (3 min × ₹1)	₹3.00
Total fare	**₹133**

Source: G.O. Ms. No. 366, Home (Transport-I) Department, 27.10.2026. Minimum fare ₹50 for the first 1.8 km, then ₹25 per km; waiting ₹1 per minute; night 1.5×. Rounded to the nearest rupee (rounding rule to be confirmed with the Department).

WHO BENEFITS

Good for the Government, passengers and drivers

For the Government

Tariff policy that is enforced

Notified fares are applied automatically on every trip. A new order is configured once and takes effect statewide.

Privacy-safe mobility data

Aggregated demand, trip times, fare accuracy and complaint statistics for CUMTA planning, with no personal details shared.

Support for gig workers

Transparent earnings records that can help with welfare-board registration and benefits.

Faster emergency response

SOS with trip, vehicle and location details, ready to connect to 112 and the police if approved.

Possible revenue

A share of platform charges, if a public-private arrangement is agreed. See the planning calculator below.

Audit and accountability

Every fare, fee and admin action is recorded with an audit trail that the Government can inspect.

Revenue planning scenario

Simple arithmetic to support discussion. This is not an income forecast and no revenue share has been agreed.

Active drivers **10,000**

Paid days per month **22**

Government share, if agreed **10%**

Platform charges per month

₹22.0 lakh

Platform charges per year

₹2.64 crore

Government share per year

₹26.4 lakh

Before costs and taxes. Running costs (servers, SMS, maps, support, insurance administration) are paid from platform charges.

For passengers

A fair meter on the street

Stopped an auto on the road? Start the meter and pay the Government fare, with no bargaining.

The Government's fare, not the company's

Every trip uses the notified tariff, so the price can't change because of a company's demand pricing.

Proof in hand

An itemised receipt that quotes the Government order: the same one the driver sees.

Overcharging you can prove

Report an overcharge straight from the receipt, measured against the official fare.

Also included: SOS, 112 / 181 shortcuts, trip OTP, trusted contacts and Tamil and English screens.

For drivers

The Government's fare backs you

Fares come from the official tariff, not from an app company, so no one can cut the rate on a driver.

No more arguments

The passenger sees the same receipt, quoting the G.O., which settles fare disputes on the spot.

Street trips count too

Hailed trips are metered and recorded, not just app bookings, so all of a driver's work is on record.

Records the Government recognises

Earnings records that can be linked to Gig Workers Welfare Board registration and benefits.

Also included: a flat ₹10 fee on working days instead of commission, document expiry reminders, SOS, and optional insurance through a licensed insurer.

NOT JUST AN IDEA

Already designed, built and tested

A working Android app, a backend and an operations dashboard exist today. The screens below are from the real app, in English and Tamil.

80

designed mobile screens for passengers and drivers

2

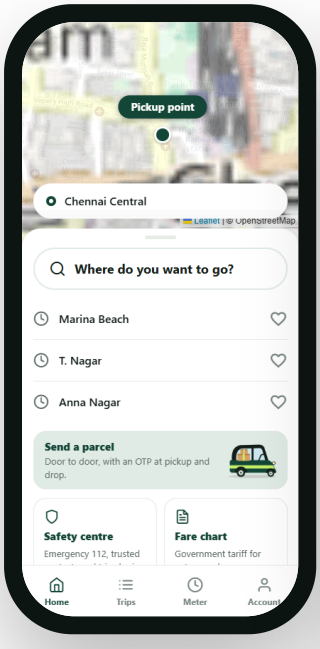
languages on every screen: Tamil and English

83

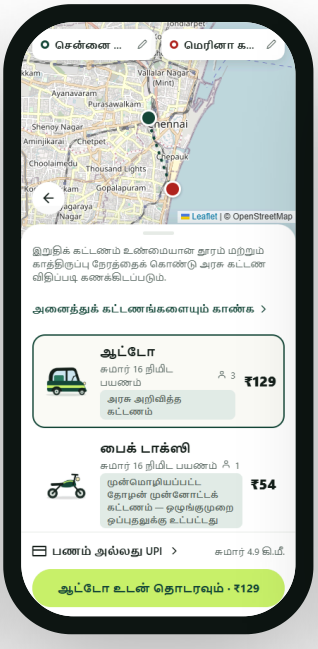
automated backend and fare tests, all passing

1

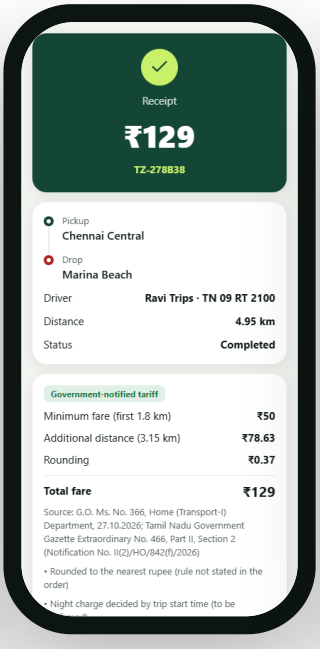
physical Android phone with the full trip flow tested



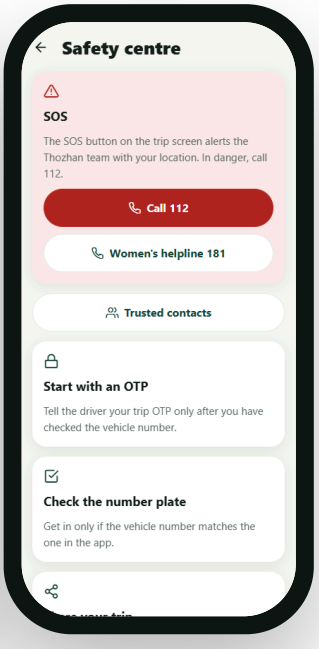
Passenger home



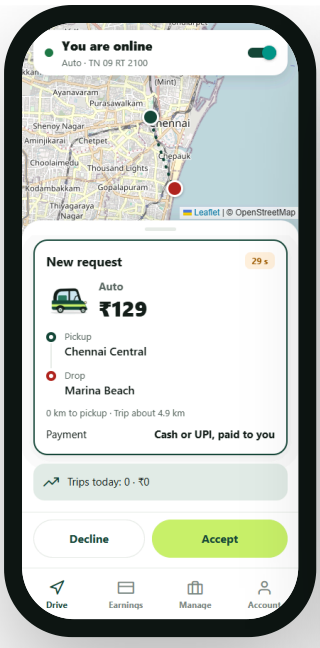
Vehicle choice in Tamil



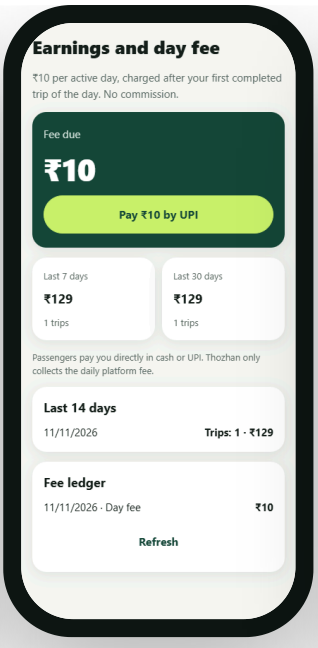
Itemised receipt



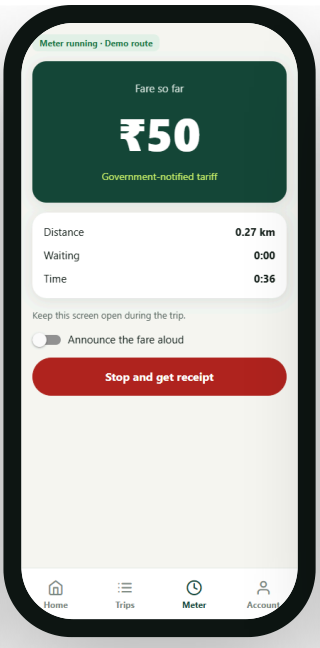
Safety centre



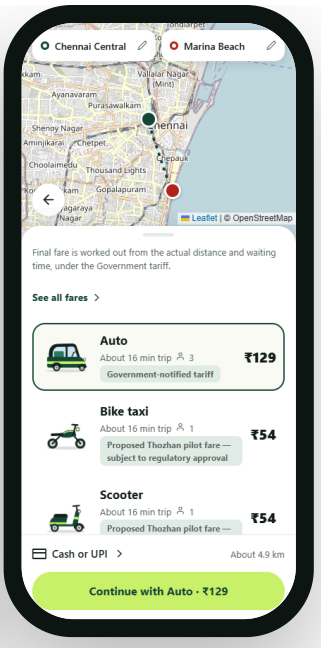
Driver trip request



Driver earnings records



Street-hail meter



Autos, bikes, cabs, parcels

Complete UX prototype

All 80 passenger and driver screens, clickable.

https://mukesh-areo.github.io/Thozhan/ux/

Open the prototype →

Interactive web demo

Book a ride, run the meter and see the driver side, in Tamil and English.

https://mukesh-areo.github.io/Thozhan/demo/

Open the demo →

Source code

App, backend, tests and documentation, open for review.

github.com/Mukesh-areo/Thozhan

View on GitHub →

SERVICES AND SAFEGUARDS

Every service only with the right approval

Services

Auto (booked and street hail)	Notified tariff
Bike taxi and scooter	Subject to approval
Cab	Subject to approval
Parcel delivery (bike and auto)	Subject to approval

Only autos would run in the first pilot. Each other service can be switched on centrally, only after the Government approves it and its fares.

Safeguards built in

- Driver documents and vehicle verified before going online
- Trip OTP and number-plate check before every ride
- Parcel declaration and photos at pickup and delivery
- Personal data minimised; passengers can download or delete their data
- Complete audit trail of fares, fees and admin decisions

PROPOSED PILOT

Start small, measure honestly, then decide

A bounded Chennai auto pilot, with results published against an agreed baseline before any expansion.

1

PHASE 0

Approvals

Nodal officer, tariff and licence clarity, security review, driver consultation.

2

PHASE 1

Closed pilot

50–150 verified auto drivers in one service area, with staffed support and incident handling.

3

PHASE 2

Measure and publish

Fare accuracy, pickup times, driver take-home pay, complaints resolved, accessibility.

4

PHASE 3

Expand if approved

More areas and services only after an independent review.

GOVERNMENT SUPPORT NEEDED

What we respectfully request

Thozhan cannot succeed as a private app alone. A fair public meter needs the Government's guidance and backing.

CUMTA

Guidance on the pilot area, integration with public transport, and use of aggregated mobility data.

Transport and Road Safety Department

Confirmation of how the notified auto tariff applies to the digital meter, aggregator requirements, and policy for bike and cab services.

Transport Commissionerate

A process to verify driver licences, permits and vehicle documents.

TNeGA

Hosting, data-protection and security-audit guidance, and possible e-governance integration.

Labour Welfare and Gig Workers Welfare Board

Linking drivers' earnings records to welfare registration and benefits.

Finance Department

Review of the ₹10 platform charge, revenue-share options and the pilot budget.

Police and emergency response

Connecting the SOS feature to 112 and women's helpline 181 workflows.

A nodal officer

One point of contact to coordinate departments and approve a defined pilot.

TRANSPARENCY

Current limitations

- **Not yet in public service.** The app has been tested on a test server and a real phone, not with live passengers.
- **Approvals pending.** Bike, scooter, cab and parcel fares are proposals until approved.
- **Tariff details to confirm.** Rounding and night-charge rules need confirmation from the Department.

- **Figures are scenarios.** Revenue and savings numbers are planning arithmetic, not guaranteed outcomes.
- **Insurance** would be offered only through a licensed insurer.
- **Before launch:** security audit, production hosting, SMS registration and staffed support are still required.

நம் நகரம். நம் மக்கள். நம் பயணம்.

Let's build fair mobility for Tamil Nadu together

We request 30 minutes to present Thozhan to the appropriate officers.

Proposed by **Mukesh**, independent developer, Thirunindravur, Tamil Nadu

Thozhan · தோழன் · A citizen-led proposal. Not endorsed by or affiliated with the Government of Tamil Nadu.

Online version: https://mukesh-areo.github.io/Thozhan/